

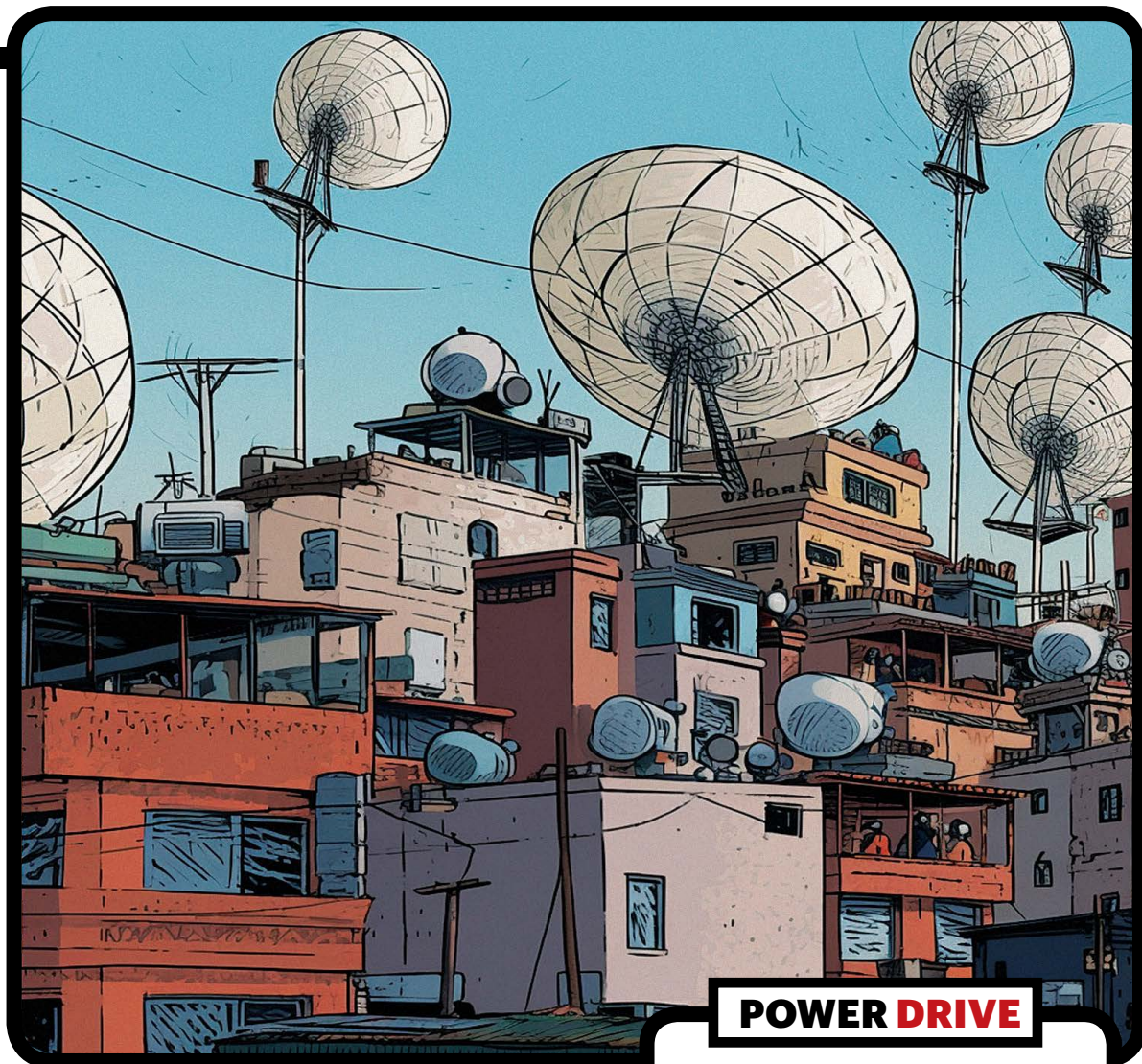


ILLUSTRATION BY NILANJAN DAS

upcoming properties like the Asia Cup and the World Cup. On Asia Cup, [we will promote] the World Cup and then on the World Cup, India's tour of South Africa and Pro Kabaddi. Building a round-the-year portfolio of cricket helps direct audiences, builds stronger connections with fans and creates non-linear growth in value."

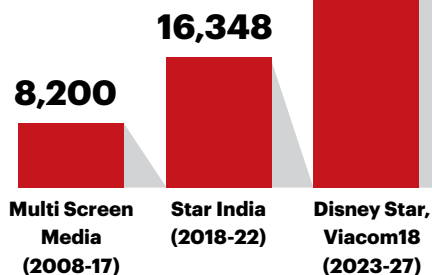
Getting back to how effective cricket is for businesses, let's look at water purifier maker Kent RO Systems, one of the principal sponsors of the Sunrisers Hyderabad team. The company, at one point, was the title sponsor of Kings XI Punjab (now called Punjab Kings). "IPL offers mass reach and where else will you get TVRs (television viewer ratings or the percentage of the population watching a show) of 4-5?" asks Mahesh Gupta, the company's Chairman & MD. As for IPL ad spots being expensive, he says that his company's logo is visible for one and a half hours or half the duration of the game. "The tournament runs for two months and every match is interesting, compared to the World Cup where viewership is only for the India matches. The IPL is expensive but gives the advertiser an assured audience." Of his overall advertising

POWER DRIVE

The cost of media rights has also zoomed multiple times since the birth of the IPL

48,390

Figures in ₹ crore



Source Official announcements, media reports